Piers McCaffrey

This version: November 2026

Department of Music • Mersey Institute of Performing Arts
Liverpool, United Kingdom
Fictional example

piers.mccaffrey@example.org
www.example.org
Citizenship: British

Education

PhD in Music (part-time) 1972 – 1979
Woolton College of Music, Liverpool, UK
• *Advisors*: Jim Lemon, Greg Henderson, and Rowan Shaw

Master of Music in Composition 1967 – 1969
Woolton College of Music, Liverpool, UK

Certificate in Studio Engineering (part-time) 1963 – 1965
St John's Wood School of Recording, London, UK

Diploma in Music and Performance 1957 – 1960
Mount Street School of Music, Liverpool, UK

Research Interests

Collaborative songwriting • Melodic bass lines • Analogue recording

Publications

A Day in the Studio. Piers McCaffrey, Glen Morton, and Gus Ellery. *Four-Track Review*, 2007.
• Published version • Working paper

Free as a Fragment. Piers McCaffrey, Greg Henderson, and Rowan Shaw. *Four-Track Review*, 1995.
• Published version

The Long and Winding Bass Line. Piers McCaffrey and Sidney Weller. *Violin Bass Quarterly*, 1982.
• Published version

With a Little Help from the Rhythm Section. Piers McCaffrey and Rowan Shaw. *Backbeat Review*, 1982.
• Published version

Something Beneath the Melody. Piers McCaffrey and Greg Henderson. *Violin Bass Quarterly*, 1969.
• Published version

Working It Out in the Middle Eight. Piers McCaffrey and Jim Lemon. *Backbeat Review*, 1965.
• Published version

Professional Experience

Emeritus Lecturer in Music 2012 – present
Mersey Institute of Performing Arts, Liverpool, UK

Founding Lecturer in Songwriting 1996 – 2012
Mersey Institute of Performing Arts, Liverpool, UK

Bandleader and Co-producer, Airfoils 1971 – 1981
Co-founded with Linda McCaffrey (keys and vocals) and Daniel Lyle (guitar)

Songwriter and Studio Arranger 1966 – 1970
EMI Studios, Abbey Road, London, UK

Touring Guitarist, Bassist, and Vocalist 1960 – 1966
Liverpool and Hamburg club dates (1960–1962), moving to violin bass in 1961
• *The Ed Sullivan Show*, New York (9 February 1964)

Conferences, seminars, and summer schools

Presenter

2008: Liverpool Sound Symposium (June), St. Pauli Recording Forum, Hamburg (September)

1996: Opening masterclass, Mersey Institute of Performing Arts, Liverpool (June)

Attendee

Songwriting Retreat, Rishikesh, India Spring 1968
- Modal melody and drone accompaniment
- Acoustic guitar and group singing

Teaching Experience

Here Comes the Countermelody (graduate level) 2004 – 2012
Mersey Institute of Performing Arts, Liverpool, UK

Getting Back to Ensemble Playing 1999 – 2008
Mersey Institute of Performing Arts, Liverpool, UK

Across the Barline 1987 – 1995
Woolton College of Music, Liverpool, UK

Departmental and Professional Service

Refereeing

Backbeat Review

Organising

Come Together Songwriting Exchange 2002 – 2011
Paired student writers with local recording groups

Four-Track Recording Workshop 1997 – 2003

Mersey Oratorio Workshop 1991
Co-led with Clive Draper after the Liverpool Cathedral premiere

Other

Curator, Linda McCaffrey Photography Archive 1999 – 2009
Catalogued photographs from recording sessions and tours

Scholarships and Awards

Mersey Institute: Penny Lane Award for Community Music 2008

Cavern Music Society: Blackbird Prize for Guitar Composition 1997

Mount Street School of Music: Golden Slumbers Prize for Vocal Arrangement 1982

Woolton College of Music: Two of Us Fellowship in Collaborative Composition 1972 – 1979

St John's Wood School of Recording: Studio Engineering Bursary 1963 – 1965

Mount Street School of Music: Performance Scholarship 1957 – 1960

Skills

Instruments	Voice, melodic bass, slide guitar, and drums Piano and hand percussion
Production	Vocal arrangement, four-track recording, and tape editing
Software	Waves Abbey Road plug-ins (REDD Consoles, J37 Tape, and Reel ADT)
Languages	English (native), Scouse (native dialect)